Event Lodging & Hosting at Villa Koukouvayia:
Answers to some FAQs



Finding a Best Fit for Your Stay…and Celebration

Villa Koukouvayia Farms will serve as the perfect place to lodge friends and family during a destination celebration in Western Crete—and its location and grounds offer beautiful spaces to site a truly memorable ceremony with up to 100 guests. As a dedicated lodging platform vs. celebration venue, the estate offers both advantages (far more intimate, far less expensive) and disadvantages (smaller celebration capacities for larger & logistically complex events). And while it's easy to integrate your event here—where your friends, family & loved ones are actually staying—it's equally easy to take advantage of Villa Koukouvayia Farms intimate lodgings for your group but host the event itself at one of the many equally beautiful celebration venues nearby.

Your decision about whether to include the celebration here at the farm will emerge as you balance the event's complexity and size against the intimacy you desire and the budget you hope to achieve, but we can help you think through those dynamics and find the best fit. We've been enjoying the island and helping others do the same for more than twenty years, and we would love to have you (and your group!) join us in that experience.

Of course, while the event itself might easily highlight your planning attention, let's talk first about how Villa Koukouvayia Farms can serve to lodge your family, friends & loved ones for the days surrounding your celebration.

Lodging at Villa Koukouvayia Farms

Villa Koukouvayia Farms is a unique property, with unique residences, rooms and capacities. By design, she is not a hotel filled with a bank of identical rooms, but a home to share with those who want such ambience. And while her lodging capacities are unique, their flexibility is her greatest asset, whether for a strategic program needing a coherent campus for multiple private individuals, or a large, loving family or friendship group seeking a unified estate for gathering or event celebration.

To ensure that your group's lodging needs are comfortably met, review the table below. The numbers describe, from a variety of perspectives, the estate's sleeping capacities. They include what is possible and what we might suggest based on your group's needs.

Villa Koukouvayia Lodging Capacities	VKF Estate	Main House	Guest House	Garden Suite
Private Bedrooms:	8	3	2	3
Single Beds:	14	1	2	11
Couple's Bedding:	6	2	1	3
Full Baths:	5	2	1	2
Half-Baths:	2	1	1	0
Nominal Sleeping Capacity:	15—20	5	4	6—11
Additional Sleep Areas:	6	3	2	1
Additional Single Bedding Available:	6	4	2	0
Additional Couple's Bedding Available:	1	0	0	1
Additional Sleeping Capacity:	8	4	2	2
Max Capacity Recommended:	24	7	4	13
Max Capacity Allowed:	28	9	6	13

Note: For events needing capacities beyond Villa Koukouvayia, or with a desire to house celebrants (like a bridal party) nearby vs. onsite, we have relationships with several nearby homes—one of which is a charming private cottage only a few steps through the olive groves from VKF's estate. We can often secure these homes at discounted rates and easily integrate the cost within your invoice.

Occupancies Included & Available

To fairly price a variety of group sizes, we set base rates to allow inexpensive stays for smaller groups, then use a supplement (€13/extra-guest/night) to let larger groups match costs to their lodging needs & value. The next table specifies guests included in the rates that follow, & those allowed at extra charge.

Guest Capacities	VKF Estate	Main House	Guest House	Garden Suite
Guests Included in Base Rate:	16	6	4	6
Extra Guests Allowed w/Supplement:	12	3	2	7

Note: Infants under 2 years at the time of arrival are not counted in these limits or pricing.

Calculating Costs

Your costs will include three elements: lodging your group, hosting your event, and arranging the services that make both your event and destination experience memorable. In whatever capacity we might participate, our goal is to be fair & transparent in our charges, and to avoid surprises once you decide to stay with us. For instance, Greek taxes paid on your behalf are progressive, confusing and high. To keep your costs low we cap the rental tax @ the VAT rate of 24%. To ensure you don't worry about *any* of it, we include every tax in the worksheets below and will do the same in any offer we share with you. Simply put, we want you to know all costs before deciding to stay with us. (And if comparing Villa Koukouvayia's to others', make sure they too are fully inclusive!)

1. Lodging Rates

Costs for many celebration elements will vary, but as the most stable & predictable expense, your group's lodging costs are a good place to start building your budget. The table below lists Villa Koukouvayia's base lodging rates by season. Each rate, multiplied by the days you will lodge your group, will include all lodging amenities from the afternoon of your arrival until the morning of your departure. As you can imagine, the majority of labor that creates your group's comfortable stay occurs in the fixed costs of preparing the estate. So that we can spread those expenses across lower rates and welcome shorter stays, we do have a minimum charge, easily calculated at 7x your nominal reservation rate. Should you prefer a shorter stay, an example at typical occupancy is shown in the table.

2. Event Hosting Rates

You may choose to lodge with us & hold your event offsite, or to integrate the celebration onsite. Because large events burden facilities well beyond nominal lodging use, with deeper facility prep, greater parking needs, and catering & other third-party organizations operating onsite, most platforms cover these costs by raising daily rates across all guests, even for those guests only lodging on site. To avoid such surcharging and keep prices transparent, we simply invoice large (see Note-1 below) onsite celebrations at a fee equal to 2.5 x the date's nominal reservation rate. That event supplement is also listed in the table below.

Note 1: The above fee only applies to larger celebrations of 30 to 100 guests onsite. For smaller events—even special events like weddings—we don't apply this charge.

Note 2: Our low event rates assume you will also lodge your group here. For those who want to use the estate's grounds only for the event, we have a minimal event-only charge equal to 4.5 x the date's nominal rate.

Lodging & Event Costs				
Season/Month	Lodging Daily Rate (16 guests)	Lodging Minimum	Lodging + Event Supplement	Event Only
January & February	€ 295	€ 2,044	€ 730	€ 1,312
March & December	€ 357	€ 2,478	€ 885	€ 1,591
April & November	€ 399	€ 2,706	€ 961	€ 1,730
May & October	€ 499	€ 3,400	€ 1,209	€ 2,177
June & September	€ 629	€ 4,312	€ 1,536	€ 2,763
July & August	€ 790	€ 5,440	€ 1,939	€ 3,489

Note1: Rates include all taxes & fees, but as noted above, are priced to protect groups not bringing the maximum number of guests from being overcharged. For larger groups, add €13/night for each extra guest.

Note: To ensure your arrival's timing doesn't affect costs, reservations bridging multiple rate-seasons are calculated by each day within a seasonal rate, and the two subtotals are simply added.

3. Supplemental Services & Other Event Costs

Celebrations & events rarely thrive without support services provided on the celebration day itself. More importantly, ***destination*** events—where guests arrive at considerable costs and with higher expectations—rarely thrive without providing those guests activities & services during the days surrounding the event that not only reinforce the joys and community at the heart of such an important gathering but avoid increasing your (or your coordinator's) logistical burden.

As professional retreat and program planners, we specialize in using this beautiful region of Crete—with its historic, culinary, topographic and recreational landscapes—to supercharge the joys at the heart of such gatherings. And while our skills and connections can serve to help you create a dynamic experience for your guests during the entire stay and for everyone at the event itself, for some events—particularly larger-scale weddings—we will recommend you use us only for lodging and non-event logistics, and pay the extra costs to coordinate the event itself with a dedicated wedding-planner—several of whom we can recommend based on our knowledge of their work.

For those hoping for a smaller, more intimate event on a tighter budget—especially if you're looking to integrate holistic experiences for your group that includes both the event day ***and*** the days before & beyond, we're great partners. We have a lot of experience providing transportation, food, activity &/or reservation services, either holistic or a la carte, and—most importantly—a lot of experience bringing people together to celebrate and have fun. These services include:

- Arrival Support & Coordination for each guest, including communications, special requests & other individual guest services.
- Group transportation, including but not limited to vehicle arrangements and acquisition prior to arrivals; airport transfers at arrivals & departures, and off-campus activity, meal & miscellaneous transportation.
- Food & Beverage Support, including but not limited to catered meals and snack provisions, pantry stocking for internally prepared food provision, and arrangements with restaurants & tavernas for off-campus meals.
- Cleaning & Laundry Support ranging from simple daily or bi-weekly bathroom and towel service to full bedroom services at various frequencies.
- Activity Guide &/or Leadership, including but not limited to hikes, outings, Samaria Gorge traverses, historical tours, excursion expertise and guidance, and other customized experiences that fit your attendees' interests & abilities.

Such services are easily invoiced and at the following general rates:

- Third-party arrangements at 15% above their invoice.

  Note: With our local contacts, we often garner arrangements discounted more than this % charge, resulting in you paying the same or less for the service than if self-arranged.)

- General staffing (driving, guided excursions, etc.) at expenses (e.g., gas &/or food) plus €25/hour or €150/full-day.

Other Cost Considerations

The following details may not affect your costs but bear on your payments and how we coordinate the financial aspects of your stay.

Extended-Stay Discounts

We provide season-based discounts for events lodging guests longer than two weeks.

Season/Month	14 Days	28 Days	56 Days
January & February	10%	15%	25%
March & December	7%	10%	20%
April & November	5%	7%	15%
May & October	3%	5%	10%
June & September	0%	3%	7%
July & August	0%	3%	5%

Note1: These discounts apply to base reservation costs before taxes or extra occupancy charges.

Note2: As with rates, discounts across "seasons," are calculated per-day, then subtotaled to ensure full deduction.

Damage/Security Deposits

While not affecting your net costs, once you decide to book with us, your initial payment will include a minimum security-deposit to hold that time against other requests and then later to serve as a damage-deposit during your stay. We set these amounts low to reflect typical guests but will increase them for groups that present a higher likelihood of damage, such as those bringing pets, or events with onsite third-party service providers that you (not us) arrange to cover possible damage such providers might cause.

Of course, assuming no major issues, deposits are always returned via bank transfer at departure.

Security/Reservation Deposits	Estate	3rd-Party Event Contractors
Security/Damage Deposits:	€1,000	€1,000
Pet Damage Deposit Supplement (Max 2):	€200/pet	

Note: We never confuse 'damage' with 'use.' Yes, we assume you will ensure your group respects Villa Koukouvayia, but we also expect you to use the facility and enjoy yourself during your stay. And we've been hosting groups long enough to understand that any gathering of happy people—particularly if happy children are part of the mix—will drop a glass or two. And while we don't like broken glass, we do like it when you're happy!

Reserving Your Time & Payment Plans

Smaller reservations are typically booked via full payment of the reservation's cost & security deposit. Larger reservations over €3,000 can qualify for 2, 3 or 4 payments depending on the reservation's value and the length of time between booking and your arrival. When you submit your inquiry, we will automatically calculate those options & share the details in our offer.

Cancellation Policy

We will always work to rebook cancelled stays, will refund all payments to the degree we have rebooked that time, and we will never charge a fee for this service. While this is often easily done, especially with an early warning of your need to cancel, it cannot be guaranteed

Currency

As our location demands, we charge in Euros. We can accept USD payment if you wish, and unlike all other banks, card-processors and third-party platforms, our offer will reflect the simple IMF exchange rate on the day we make that offer, and held for 7 days beyond, with no surcharges or extra fees.

Payment Methods

We encourage direct (IBAN or, in the USA, intrabank) transfers that are easy, safe and free. We *can* accept payments through credit cards and are happy to do so, but unlike larger third-party sites, we do not hide the inevitable payment-processing fees across all our rates and in doing so charge all customers the 3.5% to 5% fee from which only a few customers benefit. Card options and the processing details will be itemized in any offer we send, so you can choose a payment method that works best for you.

Any Other Questions?

Your ceremony, like you, should be special. So call us. Let's set up a video-chat where you can share your hopes for the event, and we'll be honored to help!

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